THE AI SIDE HUSTLE SECRET

15 Practical Ways to Make Money Using Artificial Intelligence

A BEGINNER-FRIENDLY FIELD GUIDE

Learn practical AI-assisted skills.
Build useful services. Find customers.
Deliver work people can trust.

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Artificial intelligence systems can produce inaccurate, outdated, biased or fabricated outputs. Verify facts, figures, legal requirements, citations, product claims and client-facing information before using them. Do not submit confidential client data to an AI service unless you have permission and have checked the service's privacy and data-use terms.

The tools and platform features discussed in this book may change. Availability, pricing, regional access, usage limits and commercial-use terms can differ by country, account type and date. Check each provider's current official documentation before paying for a plan or using an asset commercially.

How to use this book

Read the foundations first, then choose one income path and complete its practical assignment. Do not attempt to launch all 15 services at once. Build one skill, create proof of work, test demand with real prospects, refine your offer and only then expand.

The objective is not to make AI do everything. The objective is to use AI responsibly to solve a real customer problem and deliver a result worth paying for.

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How to Get the Most from This Book

This book is designed for people who want to learn practical ways to use artificial intelligence as part of a service or small digital business. It is written primarily for Nigerian readers, while the methods can also be adapted to other markets.

What this book will and will not do

It will show you how to select an opportunity, learn the workflow, create a sample deliverable, define a service, find prospects, quote a job, complete the work and improve through feedback. It will not promise effortless income, overnight success or guaranteed clients. AI is a tool; customers pay for outcomes, reliability and judgement.

A sensible learning sequence

1. **Choose one chapter.** Select a service that matches your interests, device, time and access to customers.
2. **Learn the workflow.** Follow the steps and reproduce the example using your own fictional practice brief.
3. **Build proof.** Create two or three honest portfolio samples. Label practice projects clearly.
4. **Test demand.** Speak with potential customers and ask about their needs before buying expensive subscriptions.
5. **Deliver carefully.** Use a written brief, confirm the scope, check the work and obtain approval.
6. **Review the economics.** Track time, expenses, revisions, platform fees and actual cash received.

Demographic and market orientation

The primary reader profile is an adult beginner or early-stage digital worker, broadly around ages 18–35, who wants practical skills for freelance work, a side business or better business operations. Secondary readers include small-business owners, working professionals, career changers and adults aged 36–55 who want to use AI to improve an existing activity. These are editorial target segments, not a claim that every person in an age group behaves alike.

The book prioritises smartphone-accessible workflows and low-cost entry points, but it does not assume every task can be completed comfortably on a phone. Website building, detailed editing, automation design and large file management are generally easier on a laptop. Readers should choose workflows that fit their actual equipment and internet access.

Reader segment	Likely objective	Design response in this book
Beginner / student / recent graduate	Learn a marketable skill and build proof	Plain-language instructions, practice briefs and portfolio tasks
Job seeker / career changer	Create service income or improve employability	CV, freelancing, portfolio and outreach workflows
Small-business owner	Improve marketing and reduce repetitive work	Content, WhatsApp, e-commerce and automation chapters
Working professional	Create a controlled side service	Time planning, service packaging and client boundaries
Creator / freelancer	Improve output and client delivery	Copywriting, video, digital products and client systems

Nigeria-first, globally adaptable

Examples use Nigerian business settings, Naira illustrations and channels such as WhatsApp, Instagram and local business outreach. International platforms and remote-client workflows are included where useful. Before using any platform, check whether it supports your country, payment method, identity verification and withdrawal route.

DataReportal's Digital 2026: Nigeria report estimates 109 million internet users in October 2025, representing 45.5% internet penetration, and 47.8 million social-media user identities. These are contextual indicators, not a count of reachable buyers or paying customers. Social-media identities are not necessarily unique individuals, and platform advertising reach is not the same as active usage. [1]

PART I — FOUNDATIONS

Before You Choose an AI Side Hustle

A side hustle is a small income-generating activity pursued alongside other responsibilities. An AI-assisted side hustle uses AI tools to support research, drafting, design, production, analysis or administration. The customer is not paying because you used AI. The customer is paying because you solved a problem.

The value equation

A service becomes commercially useful when it combines a customer problem, a credible deliverable, a clear process and dependable communication. For example, a shop owner may not need 'AI content'. The owner may need eight clear product posts, accurate prices, a consistent look and files ready to publish.

Five foundations to learn before selling

1. **Problem discovery:** Ask what the customer wants to achieve, what is currently difficult and what a successful result would look like.
2. **Tool literacy:** Learn what the tool can and cannot do. Know export formats, usage limits, privacy settings and commercial-use restrictions.
3. **Quality control:** Check facts, spelling, visual defects, accessibility, links and technical requirements.
4. **Business basics:** Define scope, price, deadline, payment terms, revisions and ownership of final files.
5. **Customer acquisition:** Build a portfolio, approach relevant prospects respectfully and follow up without spamming.

How to select your first opportunity

Question	What to consider
Do I understand the customer?	Can I name a real type of buyer and the problem they need solved?
Can I make a sample?	Can I produce a credible example without pretending it is client work?
Can I deliver with my device?	Will the workflow work on my phone or laptop and current internet connection?
Can I access the tools?	Are they available in my country, and can I afford the required plan?
Can I reach prospects?	Do I know where these businesses or customers can be found?
Can I verify the result?	Can I judge whether the final output is accurate and useful?

A minimum viable setup

- A smartphone or laptop with a supported browser and enough storage.
- A professional email address and a reliable way to communicate with customers.
- A folder system for briefs, drafts, approved work and invoices.
- A basic spreadsheet to track leads, jobs, payments and expenses.
- One primary AI assistant and one production tool for the service you choose.
- A backup plan for internet interruptions and tool outages.

Do not subscribe to every tool mentioned in this book. Start with free or low-cost access where available, test the workflow and upgrade only when a paid feature is necessary for a confirmed job.

CHAPTER 1 — AI-POWERED GRAPHIC DESIGN

Create flyers, promotional graphics and social media designs businesses can use.

Businesses need clear visual communication: product promotions, event announcements, menus, service lists and social posts. AI can help develop concepts, copy and supporting imagery, while a design editor gives you control over layout. The sellable skill is not pressing a template button; it is turning a brief into a readable, accurate and on-brand design.

Who can buy this service?

Restaurants, fashion vendors, salons, schools, event planners, property agents, coaches, religious organisations and online sellers.

Tools and setup

ChatGPT or another AI assistant for copy and concepts; Canva or Adobe Express for layout; Photopea for more detailed image editing; a permitted image-generation tool for original supporting visuals. Check asset licences and commercial-use terms before delivery.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Choose one design niche for your first portfolio. For example, start with restaurant promotions rather than claiming to design everything.
2. Collect a complete brief: business name, offer, product or service, audience, location, contact details, logo, brand colours, required size, deadline and call to action. Confirm spelling and prices in writing.
3. Ask the client for original product photographs where accuracy matters. Do not replace a real product with a generated image that misrepresents its appearance.
4. Use an AI assistant to develop three headline directions and short supporting copy. Tell it not to invent discounts, product features, testimonials or contact information.
5. Sketch the information hierarchy before opening the editor: business identity, main message, hero visual, supporting details and call to action.
6. Create the correct canvas size for the destination. Common starting sizes include 1080 × 1350 pixels for portrait social posts and 1080 × 1920 pixels for story/status layouts; confirm current platform specifications before export.
7. Build the layout using a small, consistent type system, strong contrast, clear spacing and alignment. Keep essential text away from edges and avoid overcrowding.
8. Use AI-generated visuals only as supporting assets where appropriate. Inspect hands, faces, product details, labels and text artefacts. Never present generated product imagery as an exact photograph of the client's actual goods.
9. Proofread every line against the approved brief. Verify the phone number, price, address, dates, spelling, spelling of names and any promotional conditions.
10. Export a preview and inspect it at normal phone size. Ask a second person to read it if possible. Correct legibility, crop, contrast and alignment issues.
11. Send a low-resolution or watermarked preview if that is part of your agreed process. Obtain approval, complete the agreed revisions and deliver final files in the requested formats.

12 Archive the final approved file and the source project according to your agreement. Do not reuse a client's logo, photograph or private information in your portfolio without permission.

How to price the service

Quote by scope, not by the number of clicks. Define number of designs, sizes, copywriting, image sourcing, editable files, delivery time and revision rounds. A simple local flyer, a multi-size campaign and a complete brand kit are different jobs. Research comparable providers in your market and calculate your time, tool costs and desired margin.

How to find customers

Build five to eight clearly labelled sample projects for fictional brands. Approach businesses whose current promotional material suggests a specific design need. Send a short personalised message, show one relevant sample and ask whether they would like a quote. Do not send unsolicited bulk files or imply you are already their designer.

Common risks and quality controls

Template overuse, poor typography, invented claims, distorted AI imagery, unlicensed assets, copied logos, incorrect contact details and unlimited revisions.

Practical assignment

Create a restaurant flyer, a fashion promotion and a product advertisement for fictional businesses. For each, keep the brief, draft, final export and a one-paragraph explanation of the design decisions. Ask three people to identify the offer and call to action within five seconds.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 2 — SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGEMENT

Plan, create and manage useful content for small businesses.

Many small businesses publish inconsistently or struggle to explain their products clearly. A social media manager helps plan content, prepare posts, maintain a consistent voice and review basic performance. AI can speed up brainstorming and drafting, but the manager must understand the business and approve every post.

Who can buy this service?

Local retailers, restaurants, salons, service providers, coaches, community organisations and small online brands.

Tools and setup

ChatGPT for content planning and drafting; Canva for graphics; Meta Business Suite for eligible Facebook and Instagram planning; Google Sheets for calendars and reporting; WhatsApp Business for customer communication.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Select a business category and study five public business pages. Note common questions, product categories, customer objections and posting patterns without copying their content.
2. Hold a discovery call or send a questionnaire. Collect business goals, audience, brand voice, products, approved claims, prices, location, opening hours, contact route and topics that must not be discussed.
3. Agree on the service scope. Specify platforms, number of posts, formats, captions, community replies, approval deadlines, reporting and whether paid advertising is excluded.
4. Build a four-week content calendar. Use a mix of education, product explanation, proof supplied by the client, behind-the-scenes material, FAQs and direct offers.
5. Ask AI to generate content angles from verified business information. Require it to flag missing facts instead of filling gaps with guesses.
6. Draft each caption with one purpose: inform, demonstrate, answer an objection, invite conversation or promote an approved offer.
7. Create visual templates that use the brand's approved colours, logo and typography. Keep a consistent design system but vary the content format to avoid repetitive feeds.
8. Prepare a review sheet with post date, platform, asset, caption, objective, source of claims and approval status.
9. Send the content batch to the client for approval before scheduling. Record requested changes and obtain confirmation for prices, dates and promotional terms.
10. Schedule approved content using the platform's current native tools where available. Check that links, tags, crops and formatting survive the scheduling process.
11. Monitor comments and messages only within the agreed hours and authority. Escalate complaints, refund requests, safety concerns and sensitive issues to the business owner.
12. At month end, report meaningful indicators: reach, saves, shares, profile visits, link clicks, qualified enquiries and sales data supplied by the client. Explain limitations rather than claiming every sale came from a post.

How to price the service

Use a monthly retainer or a fixed content-batch fee. Price according to platforms, volume, original design work, filming, community management, reporting and response hours. Separate content management from paid advertising spend and ad-account management.

How to find customers

Offer a short content audit based on public posts. Identify two or three concrete improvements and show a sample content calendar. Do not guarantee follower growth, virality or sales.

Common risks and quality controls

Posting without approval, fake engagement, copying competitors, exposing customer data, using copyrighted music or images without rights, replying beyond authority and confusing reach with revenue.

Practical assignment

Create a 14-day calendar for a fictional food business with seven posts, three story ideas and two short-video concepts. Include captions, creative direction, objective and approval checklist.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 3 — AI COPYWRITING

Write clearer marketing messages, product descriptions and sales content.

Copywriting is writing intended to help a reader take an action: understand an offer, request information, subscribe, book or buy. AI can produce first drafts and variations, but strong copy depends on customer research, proof, clarity and truthful claims.

Who can buy this service?

E-commerce sellers, service businesses, agencies, coaches, restaurants, real estate firms and content creators.

Tools and setup

An AI assistant for research synthesis and drafting; Google Docs for collaboration; a spreadsheet for message testing; a grammar checker where useful. Verify all factual claims independently.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Choose one copywriting deliverable: product page, short ad, email sequence, landing page, service description or WhatsApp campaign. Do not sell every format before learning one.
2. Interview the client or review approved source material. Record audience, problem, desired outcome, product features, verified benefits, price, limitations, proof, objections and call to action.
3. Separate facts from assumptions. Mark any claim that needs evidence, such as performance, health, financial, environmental or comparative claims.
4. Build a message brief. State the single reader, single problem, single offer and single next action for the piece.
5. Ask AI for several message angles. Request plain-language alternatives and a list of questions where information is missing. Do not ask it to invent testimonials or statistics.
6. Draft a structure. For an ad, use hook, problem or context, offer, evidence or explanation, and call to action. For a product page, use headline, audience fit, features, substantiated benefits, how it works, limitations, FAQs and order instructions.
7. Rewrite the draft in the client's natural brand voice. Remove exaggerated promises, generic phrases, unsupported urgency and claims that cannot be substantiated.
8. Check reading level and mobile readability. Use short paragraphs, descriptive headings and specific language. Avoid jargon unless the audience expects it.
9. Verify product names, prices, dates, links, policies and legal disclosures against the client's approved source. Confirm that the offer is still available.
10. Create two or three variations that test one meaningful difference at a time, such as the opening angle or call to action.
11. Send the copy for client approval with a note identifying any assumptions or missing information. Keep an approval record.
12. After publication, review available results and customer feedback. Treat performance data as evidence to learn from, not proof that one wording caused every sale.

How to price the service

Quote by deliverable and research depth. A short caption, a researched sales page and a multi-email sequence require different effort. Include interview time, revisions, fact-checking and usage rights in your quote.

How to find customers

Create a small portfolio showing before-and-after rewrites using fictional examples. Explain the problem each rewrite solves: clarity, structure, product explanation or stronger call to action.

Common risks and quality controls

Hallucinated facts, unsupported claims, plagiarism, tone mismatch, fake scarcity, invented reviews, unclear refund conditions and writing that sounds generic.

Practical assignment

Choose a real product you can accurately describe or invent a fictional one. Write a product description, a short social ad and five FAQs. Highlight every claim that would require evidence.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 4 — WEBSITE AND LANDING-PAGE CREATION

Build simple, useful web pages for businesses and creators.

A website can help a business explain its offer, show proof, answer common questions and receive enquiries. AI website builders and coding assistants can accelerate drafting, but a useful site still needs accurate content, responsive layout, accessible navigation, working forms and ongoing maintenance.

Who can buy this service?

Small businesses, consultants, event organisers, professionals, local service providers and creators.

Tools and setup

A website builder or CMS; an AI assistant for site structure and copy; Google Forms or a form provider for simple enquiries; a domain registrar and hosting provider; browser testing tools.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Define the site's purpose. Decide whether it is a one-page lead-generation site, a portfolio, a service website, a product catalogue or an informational site.
2. Collect approved content: business name, services, audience, location, contact details, operating hours, photos, testimonials with permission, policies and brand assets.
3. Write a sitemap before designing. A small service site may need Home, Services, About, FAQs and Contact. Avoid pages that have no clear purpose.
4. Create a page brief for each section. State the reader question it answers and the action the visitor should take.
5. Use AI to draft a first version of the copy. Replace generic statements with specific facts supplied by the client. Never invent awards, clients, certifications or results.
6. Choose a platform based on the client's needs, budget, editing ability, portability and maintenance requirements. Compare total costs, not just the first-month price.
7. Build the page using a mobile-first layout. Use readable type, sufficient contrast, descriptive buttons, compressed images and clear headings.
8. Set up navigation and calls to action. Every button should work and lead to the expected destination.
9. Configure the enquiry form. Collect only necessary information, explain how it will be used and test submission, notifications and spam controls.
10. Add basic accessibility: meaningful alt text, keyboard-friendly controls, labels for form fields, logical heading order and adequate colour contrast.
11. Test on multiple screen sizes and browsers. Check broken links, spelling, image crops, loading speed, form behaviour, phone links and email links.
12. Connect the domain and publish only after the client approves the content. Explain who owns the domain, hosting account, source files and renewal responsibility.
13. Provide a handover document with login ownership, editing instructions, backup process, renewal dates and support boundaries.

How to price the service

Separate design/build fees from domain, hosting, premium plugins, email, maintenance and future content changes. Use milestones for larger work and specify exactly how many pages, forms and revision rounds are included.

How to find customers

Build two demo sites for distinct business types. Approach businesses with an outdated or missing site and explain one specific improvement, such as clearer service information or an easier enquiry path.

Common risks and quality controls

Broken forms, insecure plugins, weak passwords, inaccessible pages, unlicensed images, hidden recurring costs, poor mobile layouts and unclear account ownership.

Practical assignment

Create a one-page website for a fictional local service. Include hero message, service list, about section, FAQs, contact form and privacy note. Test every link and form before calling it complete.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 5 — AI-ASSISTED VIDEO CREATION AND EDITING

Produce short promotional videos and social content with a repeatable workflow.

Businesses use short videos to demonstrate products, explain services, show processes and answer questions. AI can help with scripting, captions, voice clean-up and editing assistance. Good video work still depends on a clear message, usable footage, rights-cleared assets and careful review.

Who can buy this service?

Retailers, restaurants, educators, event planners, coaches, creators and service businesses.

Tools and setup

A video editor such as CapCut or another editor; an AI assistant for scripts and shot lists; a phone camera; licensed music and stock assets. CapCut states that only materials marked for commercial use should be used for commercial projects; verify current terms before use. [2]

Step-by-step implementation

1. Agree on the objective: product demonstration, customer education, event announcement, brand introduction or offer promotion.
2. Collect the approved brief, footage, logo, product facts, target platform, duration, aspect ratio, deadline and call to action.
3. Write a short script with one central message. A 20–30 second video may use a hook, demonstration, key detail and call to action; adapt length to the platform and content.
4. Create a shot list. Specify each scene, what must appear, camera angle, on-screen text and any footage the client must provide.
5. Record original footage in good light with clean audio. Keep the camera steady, clean the lens and capture multiple takes. Do not film customers or staff without appropriate permission.
6. Organise clips into folders and rename them by scene. Keep a copy of the original footage before editing.
7. Build a rough cut first. Remove dead space, arrange the story and make sure the message makes sense without effects.
8. Add captions and on-screen text. Correct AI transcription errors, names, local-language phrases and numbers manually.
9. Add music or sound effects only when the licence permits the intended commercial use. Keep speech intelligible and avoid overpowering the voice.
10. Use AI-generated scenes or voice only when the client approves and the output does not mislead viewers about real people, products or events. Disclose synthetic elements where required by platform rules or applicable law.
11. Export a draft and review it on a phone with sound on and off. Check aspect ratio, text safe areas, spelling, audio levels, flicker and visual defects.
12. Obtain approval, complete agreed revisions and export the final format(s). Deliver a thumbnail or caption only if included in the scope.

How to price the service

Price by finished duration, complexity, filming, number of versions, captions, motion graphics, source footage and revision rounds. Editing supplied footage is not the same as filming a complete production.

How to find customers

Create three demo videos: a product demo, a service explainer and a short educational clip. Use original or properly licensed assets and label fictional brands as practice work.

Common risks and quality controls

Copyrighted music, unauthorised likenesses, synthetic misinformation, inaccurate captions, poor audio, misleading product demonstrations and unapproved footage.

Practical assignment

Produce a 20–30 second video for a fictional business. Include a written script, shot list, captions, clear call to action and a final quality-control checklist.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 6 — CV, RESUME AND CAREER DOCUMENT SERVICES

Help job seekers present their real experience clearly and professionally.

Job seekers often need help organising experience, tailoring applications and presenting achievements. AI can help structure and edit career documents, but it must never invent qualifications, employment, dates, skills or measurable results. Your value is accurate communication and document quality, not promising employment.

Who can buy this service?

Graduates, career changers, experienced professionals, job seekers and people applying for internships or scholarships.

Tools and setup

An AI assistant for editing and tailoring; Google Docs or Microsoft Word for document creation; PDF export; job description text supplied by the applicant.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Explain the service and its limits. You improve presentation and alignment; you cannot guarantee interviews, offers or visa outcomes.
2. Collect the client's existing CV, target role, job description, education, employment history, projects, skills, certifications and preferred contact details.
3. Ask the client to confirm all dates, titles, employers, qualifications and achievements. Flag gaps rather than filling them with guesses.
4. Extract the key requirements from the job description. Separate essential qualifications, technical skills, responsibilities and preferred experience.
5. Map the client's verified experience to the role. Identify relevant evidence and missing requirements without exaggerating.
6. Use AI to suggest clearer bullet points. Ask it to preserve facts and mark any proposed metric or claim that needs client confirmation.
7. Rewrite bullets using action, task and result where the evidence supports it. If there is no verified metric, describe the work accurately without fabricating a number.
8. Choose a clean, readable layout. Use standard headings, consistent dates, clear section order and accessible fonts. Avoid unnecessary graphics that interfere with parsing.
9. Review spelling, grammar, contact information, date consistency and document length. Confirm whether the target employer requests a particular format.
10. Create a tailored cover letter only when the client supplies the role and relevant motivation. Avoid generic claims and false enthusiasm.
11. Export to PDF and, if agreed, provide an editable DOCX. Ask the client to inspect every detail before using the document.
12. Delete or securely store personal data according to the agreed retention period. Do not upload identity documents or sensitive records to third-party AI tools without explicit informed permission.

How to price the service

Offer clearly scoped packages: CV review, CV rewrite, role-specific tailoring or CV plus cover letter. Charge separately for multiple job applications or repeated tailoring. State that the client must verify all content.

How to find customers

Partner with student associations, career communities and professional networks. Share anonymised before-and-after examples only with permission. Avoid fear-based marketing or guaranteed-job claims.

Common risks and quality controls

Invented achievements, inaccurate dates, privacy breaches, discriminatory language, keyword stuffing and claims of guaranteed employment.

Practical assignment

Create a sample CV for a fictional applicant using only supplied fictional facts. Tailor it to a fictional job description and produce a verification checklist for the applicant.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 7 — CREATING AND SELLING EBOOKS

Turn useful knowledge into a well-researched digital product.

An ebook is valuable when it helps a defined reader solve a specific problem. AI can assist with outlining, drafting, examples and editing, but the author must provide judgement, verify claims, add original insight and ensure the material is useful. A long document is not automatically a good product.

Who can buy this service?

Readers with a defined learning need; potential buyers may be reached through an existing audience, partnerships, communities or paid advertising.

Tools and setup

An AI assistant for outlining and editing; Google Docs or Word for manuscript drafting; Canva or a publishing layout tool for design; a PDF reader for proofing; a checkout or delivery platform available in your market.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Choose a narrow reader and problem. 'Make money online' is too broad; 'how a small restaurant can plan a month of social posts' is more specific.
2. Validate the problem through interviews, community questions, search behaviour, competitor reviews and a small landing-page test. Treat interest signals as hypotheses, not proof of purchases.
3. Write a promise that is realistic and measurable. State what the reader will learn or produce, not an income result you cannot guarantee.
4. Create a chapter outline that moves from foundations to demonstration, application and troubleshooting. Remove chapters that repeat the same advice.
5. Research every factual section using reliable, current sources. Record source titles, URLs, publication dates and the claims each source supports.
6. Draft in your own editorial voice. Use AI to brainstorm or critique, but verify every example and add original workflows, templates and decisions.
7. Include worked examples, checklists, exercises, downloadable templates and clear instructions. Avoid padding the book with generic motivational text.
8. Review for factual accuracy, logic, repetition, readability, inclusivity, accessibility and copyright. Check quotes and image permissions.
9. Design a consistent interior: readable body font, restrained headings, generous margins, page numbers, running headers, tables and clear chapter openings.
10. Export the PDF and inspect every page. Check table breaks, orphan headings, clipped text, hyperlinks, page numbering and readability on a phone.
11. Create a product page with contents, audience fit, sample pages, file format, delivery method, support policy and refund terms that comply with local law and platform rules.
12. Launch to a small group first. Gather specific feedback, correct errors and only then scale promotion. Keep a changelog and issue updated editions when tools or claims change.

How to price the service

Set price after comparing competing products, depth, buyer budget, support included, payment fees and refund risk. A short checklist and a researched workbook are not equivalent products. Do not price based on page count alone.

How to find customers

Use sample pages, useful excerpts, demonstrations and transparent outcomes. Build an email or WhatsApp opt-in list with consent. Track landing-page visits, checkout starts, completed purchases, refunds and support requests.

Common risks and quality controls

Plagiarism, fabricated references, outdated tool steps, misleading promises, poor PDF rendering, unlicensed images and unclear refund/delivery terms.

Practical assignment

Create a 10-page mini-guide on a narrow problem. Include an outline, three cited sources, one worked example, one checklist and a final PDF proofing log.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 8 — PRODUCT PHOTOGRAPHY AND MOCKUPS

Create stronger product visuals while keeping product representation honest.

Online sellers need clear images that help customers understand size, features, texture and use. AI can assist with background concepts, scene composition and mockups, but it must not change a product's real appearance in a way that misleads buyers.

Who can buy this service?

Fashion sellers, skincare vendors, food businesses, homeware shops, artisans and online retailers.

Tools and setup

A smartphone camera; natural or controlled lighting; Canva or Photopea; background-removal software; an image-generation tool for clearly illustrative scenes; a simple white or neutral backdrop.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Ask what the image will be used for: catalogue listing, social post, marketplace thumbnail, banner or campaign creative.
2. Request the actual product and capture accurate photos from front, side, back, detail and scale views where relevant.
3. Clean the camera lens, use stable lighting, avoid harsh colour casts and photograph the product against a simple background.
4. Keep a reference image of the actual product. Record important details such as colour, packaging, dimensions, material and included accessories.
5. Select the best original photo and crop it without cutting off essential product details.
6. Remove or replace the background only when the result remains truthful. Preserve shadows and edges naturally; inspect hair, transparent packaging and reflective surfaces.
7. Use AI to create a background or lifestyle concept separately. Composite the real product into the scene only if the result accurately represents its appearance and scale.
8. Do not generate fake labels, ingredients, certifications, before-and-after results, medical outcomes or product features.
9. Prepare consistent image sizes and backgrounds for the client's sales channels. Follow the marketplace's current image rules.
10. Export high-quality web images at reasonable file sizes. Keep original photographs and editable working files where agreed.
11. Ask the client to approve the images and confirm that all claims and product details are accurate.
12. Deliver a set with clear filenames and a note identifying any conceptual or illustrative image.

How to price the service

Charge by number of products, number of final images, retouching complexity, scene creation, reshoots and usage. Separate photography time from editing time.

How to find customers

Create a sample set for one fictional product: original photo, clean background, detail crop and an illustrative lifestyle concept clearly labelled as such.

Common risks and quality controls

Misrepresenting the product, altering packaging or labels, fake certifications, incorrect colour, deceptive scale, unlicensed assets and marketplace policy violations.

Practical assignment

Photograph one real household item. Produce three truthful images: clean catalogue view, detail view and a lifestyle layout. Compare the final images with the original to ensure no material product detail has changed.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 9 — AI-ASSISTED FREELANCING

Turn a defined skill into a service and compete for remote or local projects.

Freelancing is selling a defined service to clients rather than relying on a single employer. AI can help with research, drafting, planning and production, but clients still expect original judgement, communication, confidentiality and reliable delivery.

Who can buy this service?

Small businesses, agencies, founders, creators and individuals who need project-based support.

Tools and setup

A portfolio site or PDF; a professional email; a project tracker; a video-call tool; freelance marketplaces where available; an AI assistant used within client confidentiality rules.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Choose one service with a clear output, such as short-form video editing, landing-page copy, presentation design or product-listing optimisation.
2. Define your ideal client and the problem you solve. Avoid a profile that lists every skill you have ever tried.
3. Create three to five portfolio samples. Explain the brief, your process and the final deliverable. Clearly label fictional or self-initiated work.
4. Write a profile headline that names the service and audience. Use the overview to explain the process, deliverables and relevant proof.
5. Research platform eligibility, fees, payment methods, identity checks and dispute policies before investing time or money. Upwork's published freelancer service fee can vary from 0% to 15% per contract; check the fee shown for each contract. [3]
6. Search for projects that match your skill, not every available job. Read the full brief and identify the client's actual problem.
7. Write a proposal that references the client's requirement, explains your relevant approach, asks one useful question if needed and links to one relevant sample.
8. Do not send mass-generated proposals. Personalise each application and never claim experience or results you do not have.
9. Before accepting work, agree on deliverables, milestones, deadlines, revision limits, communication, file ownership and payment arrangements.
10. Use AI to support planning or drafting only where permitted. Do not upload confidential client material into an AI system without permission.
11. Deliver a clear progress update before the deadline. Raise blockers early rather than disappearing.
12. Request feedback after successful completion and ask permission before using the work as a public case study.

How to price the service

For fixed-price jobs, estimate hours, complexity, revisions, platform fees and risk. For hourly work, track time accurately and explain what counts as billable. Never underquote a project you do not understand.

How to find customers

Combine marketplace applications with direct networking, referrals and a focused portfolio. A marketplace is one acquisition channel, not a complete business strategy.

Common risks and quality controls

Scams, unpaid test work, off-platform payment violations, fake credentials, scope creep, account restrictions and ignoring platform fees.

Practical assignment

Select one service, build three portfolio samples, draft a profile and prepare two tailored proposals for fictional project briefs.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 10 — DIGITAL MARKETING SERVICES

Help businesses plan campaigns, understand audiences and improve conversion paths.

Digital marketing connects a business offer with an audience through online channels. AI can support research synthesis, content planning, ad variations and reporting. It cannot replace product-market fit, honest claims, campaign strategy or sound measurement.

Who can buy this service?

Local service providers, online shops, education businesses, restaurants, professional services and startups.

Tools and setup

An AI assistant; spreadsheets; platform-native analytics; Meta Business Suite and Ads Manager where appropriate; Google Analytics or other analytics tools when configured correctly; a landing page and tracking plan.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Start with a business objective: qualified enquiries, purchases, bookings, event registrations or awareness. Avoid vague goals such as 'go viral'.
2. Understand the offer, audience, price, geography, buying process, objections and customer service capacity.
3. Review the existing customer journey: ad or post, landing page or profile, enquiry method, response time, payment and fulfilment.
4. Define one primary conversion event and a small set of supporting indicators. For example, track qualified WhatsApp enquiries rather than counting every click as a lead.
5. Develop audience hypotheses from customer interviews, existing sales data and business knowledge. Do not assume demographics alone explain buyer intent.
6. Write a campaign brief with offer, proof, creative angles, budget, dates, geography, exclusions, landing destination and measurement plan.
7. Use AI to create variations of copy and creative concepts. Check each claim, price, disclaimer and destination manually.
8. Prepare the landing page or enquiry path before launching. Test forms, phone links, response scripts and mobile usability.
9. Set a conservative test budget the business can afford to lose. Start with a clear experiment rather than changing audience, creative, offer and landing page simultaneously.
10. Monitor spend, reach, frequency, clicks, qualified leads, conversion rate and cost per result. Check for tracking errors and low-quality enquiries.
11. Report what happened, what is uncertain and what should be tested next. Do not claim causation from a small or poorly tracked sample.
12. Pause or revise campaigns when spend is not producing useful results, when the offer is unavailable or when customer service cannot handle demand.

How to price the service

Separate strategy, creative production, campaign setup, ongoing optimisation and reporting. Ad spend belongs to the client and should be clearly separated from your service fee.

How to find customers

Offer a concise funnel review. Show the business where a prospect may become confused or drop off, then propose a scoped improvement.

Common risks and quality controls

Guaranteed sales claims, policy violations, misleading targeting, poor tracking, overspending, unapproved account access and using customer data without a lawful basis.

Practical assignment

Create a campaign brief for a fictional local service. Define the objective, audience hypothesis, offer, two creative angles, landing path, budget cap and reporting metrics.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 11 — WHATSAPP BUSINESS MARKETING

Help businesses organise product information and customer conversations.

For many small businesses, WhatsApp is a practical place to answer questions, share product details and coordinate orders. WhatsApp Business provides business profiles, catalogues and messaging tools. A useful service helps the business organise its information and respond consistently without spamming people.

Who can buy this service?

Retailers, food vendors, salons, repair services, tutors, event businesses and local service providers.

Tools and setup

WhatsApp Business; a spreadsheet for product information; Canva for catalogue images; an AI assistant for drafting FAQs and reply templates.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Confirm that the client owns or controls the business phone number and has authority to make account changes.
2. Collect accurate business details: name, description, address or service area, opening hours, email, website, order process and customer support hours.
3. Organise products or services into categories. For each item, collect a clear title, accurate image, description, price where supported, availability and relevant conditions.
4. Create or improve the business profile. Use a recognisable logo or business image and a concise description that tells customers what the business offers.
5. Build the catalogue using accurate photos and descriptions. WhatsApp's official help material describes catalogue items as having a title and image, with optional details such as description and website link; price availability can vary by country. [4]
6. Draft greeting, away and quick replies that sound human and set realistic response expectations. Include escalation instructions for complaints and unusual requests.
7. Create a simple enquiry flow: identify the customer's need, confirm availability, provide the correct price and terms, explain payment or booking steps, and confirm the order.
8. Obtain consent before sending promotional messages. Respect opt-outs and platform messaging rules. Do not scrape phone numbers or add people to lists without permission.
9. Train the business owner or staff on how to update catalogue items, handle customer data and avoid sharing sensitive information.
10. Test the customer journey from a separate phone: open the profile, browse an item, send a message and confirm the response process works.
11. Review common questions after launch and improve descriptions or FAQs. Keep stock, prices and opening hours current.
12. Provide a handover guide and clarify whether you will maintain the catalogue or whether the client will manage updates.

How to price the service

Charge for setup, catalogue population, image preparation, FAQ writing and staff training. Offer maintenance separately and define how often product information is refreshed.

How to find customers

Approach businesses that receive repeated product questions or have disorganised public product information. Show how a clear catalogue and response system can reduce confusion.

Common risks and quality controls

Unsolicited bulk messaging, privacy breaches, outdated prices, inaccurate stock, mishandled complaints and unclear account ownership.

Practical assignment

Set up a demo catalogue for a fictional shop with six items, accurate descriptions, sample quick replies and a simple order workflow. Test it from a second device.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 12 — WORKFLOW AUTOMATION SERVICES

Reduce repetitive business tasks using no-code tools and carefully designed workflows.

Automation connects steps that people repeatedly perform, such as collecting a form response, adding a record to a spreadsheet and notifying a team member. AI can classify or draft information, but automation should be reliable, observable and easy to recover when something fails.

Who can buy this service?

Small service firms, agencies, training providers, event organisers, online shops and teams with repetitive admin tasks.

Tools and setup

Google Forms and Sheets; Make, Zapier or another automation platform; email or messaging integrations; an AI model only when a language task genuinely requires it.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Interview the business owner and observe the current process. Write down the trigger, each step, responsible person, systems used, exceptions and failure points.
2. Choose one small process with clear rules. Good first examples include form-to-spreadsheet logging or a notification when a new enquiry arrives.
3. Draw the workflow before building it. Mark trigger, actions, conditions, data fields, error handling and human approval points.
4. Check whether the required apps have supported integrations and whether the client has the right account permissions and subscription.
5. Minimise the data collected. Avoid automating sensitive personal, financial or health information unless the client has appropriate safeguards and a lawful basis.
6. Create a test environment using fictional records. Never experiment on live customer data without explicit approval and a rollback plan.
7. Build the trigger and first action. Run a test and inspect the exact data passed between systems.
8. Add validation and duplicate protection. Decide what should happen when a required field is missing or the same event is received twice.
9. Add an error notification and log. A workflow that silently fails is not a dependable business process.
10. If AI is used to classify or draft content, define allowed inputs, expected output format, confidence limits and a human review step for uncertain or consequential decisions.
11. Test normal cases, missing data, duplicate submissions, expired credentials and service outages. Record the result of each test.
12. Obtain client approval, deploy during an agreed window and monitor the first live runs. Document how to pause, restart and edit the automation.

How to price the service

Charge for discovery, build, testing, documentation and handover. Subscription fees and usage charges should be paid by the client directly where possible. Maintenance and monitoring require a separate agreement.

How to find customers

Look for repetitive admin work, not vague requests to 'automate the business'. Demonstrate one small workflow with fictional data and explain the time or error reduction it is intended to create.

Common risks and quality controls

Credential exposure, uncontrolled AI actions, duplicate records, silent failures, unexpected usage charges, poor access control and automating a broken process.

Practical assignment

Design a lead-capture workflow: form submission → spreadsheet row → owner notification. Use test data, add duplicate checks, document failure handling and produce a one-page handover.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 13 — ONLINE COURSES AND DIGITAL TRAINING

Package knowledge into lessons, exercises and learning resources.

A course should help a learner move from a starting level to a defined capability. AI can assist with lesson outlines, examples, quizzes and worksheets, but a course creator must understand the subject, verify content and design practice that demonstrates learning.

Who can buy this service?

Learners seeking a specific skill, professional communities, businesses training staff and organisations that need structured learning.

Tools and setup

An AI assistant; slide software; a video recorder/editor; a learning platform or private delivery space; forms or quizzes for assessment.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Choose a subject you understand well enough to teach responsibly. Do not create training on a regulated or high-stakes subject beyond your competence.
2. Define the learner, prerequisite knowledge and observable learning outcome. Replace 'understand marketing' with 'create a one-week content plan for a named business'.
3. Interview potential learners about their current difficulties, preferred format, device access, time and willingness to pay.
4. Break the outcome into modules. Each module should teach a small concept, demonstrate it and require the learner to practise.
5. Write lesson plans with objectives, explanation, demonstration, practice task, common errors and a short knowledge check.
6. Use AI to suggest examples and quiz questions, then verify the answers and remove ambiguous or misleading items.
7. Create slides that support the spoken lesson rather than reproducing a wall of text. Use readable type, diagrams and consistent visual structure.
8. Record a short pilot lesson. Check audio, pacing, screen visibility, captions and whether the learner can reproduce the task.
9. Prepare downloadable worksheets, templates or project files. Ensure they are original or licensed for redistribution.
10. Pilot the course with a small group. Observe where learners get stuck and collect specific feedback about clarity and usefulness.
11. Revise the course, publish a clear description of outcomes and prerequisites, and explain support, access duration, refund terms and technical requirements.
12. Track completion, assessment performance and learner questions. Update lessons when tools, platforms or regulations change.

How to price the service

Price according to learner outcome, instructor support, materials, access period, assessment and market alternatives. A self-paced mini-course and a live cohort with feedback require different pricing.

How to find customers

Publish a sample lesson, curriculum outline and realistic learner project. Avoid claiming that completing the course guarantees employment or income.

Common risks and quality controls

Teaching unverified information, copied materials, inaccessible video, misleading certificates, unsupported outcome claims and weak learner support.

Practical assignment

Create a 30-minute pilot lesson with one learning objective, a demonstration, a practice task, a five-question quiz and a feedback form.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 14 — YOUTUBE CONTENT PRODUCTION

Build a repeatable research, scripting and production workflow for video channels.

YouTube content can support a creator's brand, educate an audience or promote a business. AI can assist with research organisation, outlines, captions and editing. It does not guarantee views, monetisation or audience growth. Original value, accuracy, rights and consistency matter.

Who can buy this service?

Creators, educators, businesses, coaches, publishers and organisations that need video content.

Tools and setup

An AI assistant; YouTube Studio; a camera or smartphone; video editing software; licensed music and visuals; a spreadsheet for topic and performance tracking.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Choose a channel purpose and a defined audience. Decide whether the channel teaches, reviews, documents, entertains or supports a business.
2. Research audience questions using direct interviews, search suggestions, comments and reputable sources. Keep a source list for factual topics.
3. Select topics that fit the channel's expertise and can be answered with original insight or useful demonstration.
4. Write a video brief: viewer question, promise, key points, evidence, demonstration, call to action and sources.
5. Use AI to organise an outline and identify gaps. Verify facts and avoid scripts that merely paraphrase other creators' work.
6. Write a natural script with a clear opening, useful body and concise ending. Add examples, personal experience or demonstrations that make the content distinctive.
7. Prepare a shot list and collect original footage. Use visuals only when you have rights to use them.
8. Record clear audio and stable footage. If using synthetic narration or imagery, check platform disclosure rules and avoid impersonation or deceptive presentation.
9. Edit for clarity and pacing. Add accurate captions, relevant on-screen text and a thumbnail that honestly represents the video.
10. Write a searchable title and description that accurately reflect the content. Avoid keyword stuffing and misleading clickbait.
11. Publish on a sustainable schedule. Monitor audience retention, click-through rate, returning viewers and meaningful comments in context.
12. Use results to improve the next video. Do not assume one high or low result proves a topic is universally successful.

How to price the service

For client work, price by research, scripting, recording, editing, thumbnail, upload support and revision scope. Channel growth or revenue share should be handled through a separate written agreement.

How to find customers

Create three sample videos for a clear niche. Approach businesses that already publish video or have a useful subject but lack production capacity.

Common risks and quality controls

Copyright strikes, reused content, misinformation, synthetic impersonation, misleading thumbnails, policy changes and promising monetisation.

Practical assignment

Plan and produce one three-to-five-minute educational video. Keep a source list, script, shot list, caption file, thumbnail and post-publication review.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

CHAPTER 15 — E-COMMERCE SUPPORT SERVICES

Help online sellers improve product information, listings and customer operations.

Online sellers need accurate product listings, organised catalogues, clear policies and timely customer responses. AI can help draft descriptions, categorise products and prepare FAQs, but every listing must match the actual product and the marketplace's rules.

Who can buy this service?

Small online stores, marketplace sellers, fashion vendors, electronics retailers, homeware shops and niche product businesses.

Tools and setup

An AI assistant; spreadsheet; image editor; store platform or marketplace; WhatsApp Business where appropriate; analytics supplied by the seller.

Step-by-step implementation

1. Choose a product category you can understand. Learn the common product attributes, customer questions, delivery concerns and return expectations.
2. Collect a structured product feed: SKU, exact product name, variant, size, material, colour, dimensions, compatibility, price, stock status and original images.
3. Ask the seller to verify all technical specifications and claims. Never infer safety, medical, performance or compatibility details.
4. Create a listing template with title, short description, features, specifications, what's included, delivery information and FAQs.
5. Use AI to draft descriptions from the verified product feed. Require it to leave missing values blank rather than inventing them.
6. Review every listing for keyword relevance, readability, duplicate content, platform policy and accuracy. Avoid keyword stuffing.
7. Prepare images that show the real product and its variants. Keep colour and scale truthful. Add alternate views where useful.
8. Organise variants and SKUs consistently. Test that the selected size, colour or model maps to the correct price and inventory.
9. Set up customer FAQs for delivery, payment, returns, warranty and availability using the seller's actual policies.
10. Test the purchase journey from product page to checkout. Check shipping zones, tax settings where applicable, payment methods, confirmation messages and mobile usability.
11. Review customer questions and returns to identify unclear product information. Update the listing with approved answers.
12. Provide a change log and handover guide so the seller can maintain prices, stock and product details.

How to price the service

Charge by number of listings, complexity, image preparation, data cleanup, platform setup and testing. Ongoing catalogue updates should be priced separately.

How to find customers

Offer a small listing audit using public information. Show how a clearer title, complete specifications or better image order could reduce buyer uncertainty.

Common risks and quality controls

Incorrect product claims, wrong variants, stale stock, fake reviews, copied descriptions, unlicensed images and hidden checkout problems.

Practical assignment

Create five listings for a fictional shop. Use a structured product spreadsheet, verified fictional specifications, truthful images and a QA checklist.

Chapter checkpoint: Do not move on because you have read the chapter. Move on when you have completed the assignment, checked the result and recorded what you learned.

PART III — BUILD THE BUSINESS

From a Skill to a Dependable Service

A skill becomes a business only when you can repeatedly find customers, define work, deliver reliably and keep the finances under control. This section gives you a practical operating system that can be used with any of the 15 opportunities.

1. Define a narrow offer

A clear offer names the buyer, problem and deliverable. For example: 'I prepare eight branded social media posts per month for local restaurants' is easier to evaluate than 'I do AI and digital marketing'.

2. Write a one-page service scope

- Client and project name.
- Problem and intended outcome.
- Exact deliverables and file formats.
- What the client must provide.
- Timeline and approval milestones.
- Number of revision rounds.
- Price, deposit and balance due.
- Ownership, usage rights and portfolio permission.
- Support period and exclusions.

3. Calculate a sustainable price

Do not choose a price only because a competitor charges it. Estimate the work and the cost of delivery. Include research, communication, production, revisions, software, internet, payment fees, taxes where applicable and time spent finding clients.

Cost component	Question to answer
Labour	How many hours will discovery, production, review and delivery take?
Tools	Which subscriptions, credits or paid assets are required?
Transaction costs	What payment, marketplace or currency conversion fees apply?
Revisions	How much change is included and what counts as new scope?
Overhead	What share of internet, device maintenance and administration belongs to this job?
Margin	What remains after costs, and is the work worth repeating?

Illustrative calculation: if a job takes 5 hours and you choose a planning rate of ■4,000 per hour, the labour component is ■20,000. If direct costs are ■3,000, the quote must cover at least ■23,000 before any additional overhead, risk allowance or profit. This is a calculation example, not a recommended market rate.

4. Build a simple lead tracker

Date	Business / prospect	Need identified	Next action	Status
4 Nov	Example Bakery	Needs menu refresh	Send sample and ask for brief	Contacted
5 Nov	Example Tutor	Needs course flyer	Follow up after permission	Qualified
6 Nov	Example Boutique	No clear current need	Do not pressure	Not pursuing

5. Use a professional outreach process

First message: Hello [Name], I came across [Business] and noticed [specific, genuine observation]. I help [type of business] with [specific service]. I have an example relevant to this kind of work. Would it be useful if I sent it for you to review?

Follow-up: Hello [Name], just following up on my earlier message. If this is not a priority at the moment, no problem. If you would like to discuss [specific service], I can send a short scope and price.

Respect a no, an opt-out or silence. Do not repeatedly message people, scrape private contact details or misrepresent a relationship.

6. Run a reliable client workflow

1. Qualify the enquiry: confirm need, budget range, timing and decision-maker.
2. Collect a brief and clarify missing information.
3. Send a written proposal and scope.
4. Agree payment and start conditions.
5. Produce the work and provide progress updates.
6. Run your own quality check before sending a preview.
7. Collect consolidated feedback within the agreed revision rounds.
8. Deliver final files and confirm receipt.
9. Close the project, record income and costs, and request feedback.

7. Measure what matters

Metric	Meaning	Why it matters
Qualified leads	Prospects with a real need and plausible fit	Shows whether outreach is reaching relevant buyers
Proposal conversion	Accepted proposals divided by proposals sent	Indicates offer clarity and fit
Effective hourly return	Net job revenue divided by hours worked	Shows whether the price is sustainable
On-time delivery	Jobs delivered by the agreed deadline	Measures reliability
Revision rate	Jobs requiring more work than planned	Reveals briefing or quality problems
Repeat / referral work	Customers who return or refer others	Signals satisfaction and service fit

8. Protect your work and the customer

- Use strong, unique passwords and multi-factor authentication where available.

- Do not share client login credentials in plain text.
- Collect only information required for the job.
- Get permission before using client work, logos, photos or results in a portfolio.
- Keep backups of approved deliverables and important project records.
- Document who owns domains, accounts, source files and licences.
- Check local tax, consumer protection, privacy and business requirements as your activity grows.

30-DAY IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

This plan is designed to help you launch one service in a controlled way. It does not guarantee a sale within 30 days. Its purpose is to move you from passive reading to a tested offer and a repeatable process.

Period	Focus	Actions	Evidence of progress
Days 1–3	Choose and understand	Select one chapter; identify buyer, problem, tools and limitations.	One-page opportunity brief
Days 4–7	Learn the workflow	Follow the chapter tutorial; reproduce a sample; note errors.	One completed practice project
Days 8–10	Build proof	Create two more samples; label practice work honestly.	Three portfolio samples
Days 11–13	Package the service	Define deliverables, price logic, timeline and revision policy.	One-page service offer
Days 14–17	Prepare sales assets	Create a portfolio, profile and outreach message.	Public or shareable portfolio
Days 18–22	Test demand	Identify 15 relevant prospects; contact them respectfully and personally.	Lead tracker with outcomes
Days 23–26	Improve	Review replies, objections and sample quality; adjust the offer.	Revised offer and samples
Days 27–30	Run a pilot	If a suitable client agrees, deliver a small scoped project; otherwise conduct more interviews and improve validation.	Pilot delivery or documented market feedback

Daily work rhythm

- 30 minutes: learn one tool feature or business concept.
- 60–90 minutes: produce or improve a practical sample.
- 20 minutes: review quality and record lessons.
- 20 minutes: research or contact a small number of relevant prospects.

End-of-month review

1. Which task did I complete confidently without copying a tutorial?
2. Which part took longer than expected?
3. What feedback did real people give?
4. Did anyone express a specific buying intention? What evidence supports that?
5. What are my actual tool, internet and delivery costs?
6. What should I improve before accepting a larger job?

A useful 30-day result may be a stronger portfolio, a clearer offer and evidence about customer needs—even if no sale has happened yet. Do not confuse progress with guaranteed revenue.

PROMPT LIBRARY AND REUSABLE TEMPLATES

Prompts are starting instructions, not magic commands. Replace the bracketed details, provide verified source information and review every output. Do not paste private client data unless the client has given informed permission and the tool's data practices are acceptable.

A. Universal project brief prompt

Act as a careful [ROLE]. Help me complete [TASK] for [BUSINESS TYPE] serving [AUDIENCE]. The confirmed facts are: [FACTS]. The objective is: [OBJECTIVE]. The required output is: [DELIVERABLE]. Do not invent prices, claims, testimonials, dates, credentials or contact details. If information is missing, ask questions or mark it as unknown. Provide a step-by-step plan and a quality checklist.

B. Research and fact-check prompt

Review the material below. Separate verified facts, assumptions and claims requiring evidence. Identify contradictions, missing details and statements that may be misleading. Do not fill gaps with guesses. Return a table with: statement, status, evidence needed and recommended correction. Material: [PASTE NON-SENSITIVE MATERIAL].

C. Quality-control prompt

Act as a strict quality reviewer for this [DESIGN / COPY / WEBSITE / VIDEO / WORKFLOW]. Check accuracy, completeness, clarity, audience fit, accessibility, technical requirements and consistency with the brief. List each issue by severity and give a specific correction. Do not praise the work unless you can identify concrete strengths.

D. Customer discovery questions

- What are you trying to achieve?
- What is difficult about the current process?
- Who is the intended customer or user?
- What have you already tried?
- What information, assets or access can you provide?
- What does a successful result look like?
- When is the result needed?
- Who approves the work?
- What budget range have you allocated?
- What must not change or be included?

E. Simple project proposal template

Project: [Name]
Client: [Name]
Objective: [Outcome]
Deliverables: [Exact list]
Client inputs: [Assets and information]

Timeline: [Milestones]
Revisions: [Number and definition]
Fee: [Amount and currency]
Payment terms: [Deposit / milestones / balance]
Exclusions: [What is not included]
Ownership and usage: [Agreed rights]
Approval: [How the client accepts the scope]

F. Delivery checklist

- The deliverable matches the approved brief.
- Names, dates, prices, phone numbers and links are correct.
- Images, fonts, music and other assets have appropriate usage rights.
- The file opens and displays correctly on the target device.
- All agreed formats and sizes are included.
- No confidential data or internal notes are visible.
- The client has received usage or handover instructions.
- The final payment and project closure are recorded.

GLOSSARY

Term	Plain-language meaning
AI assistant	A software system that responds to instructions by generating or analysing text, images, code or other content.
Automation	A workflow that carries out defined actions when a trigger or condition occurs.
Call to action (CTA)	A clear instruction telling the audience what to do next.
Conversion	A desired action, such as a purchase, booking or qualified enquiry.
Deliverable	The agreed item or result supplied to a customer.
Landing page	A focused web page designed around one offer or action.
Lead	A person or organisation that may become a customer.
Mockup	A visual presentation of how a design or product may appear in use.
Portfolio	A curated collection of work demonstrating capability.
Prompt	An instruction or input provided to an AI system.
Scope creep	Unplanned work added beyond the agreed project scope.
SEO	Search engine optimisation: improving content and site structure so people can find relevant pages through search.
Workflow	A sequence of tasks, decisions and handoffs used to complete a process.

TOOL DIRECTORY

The following are starting points, not endorsements. Features, free limits, availability and commercial-use rules change. Confirm the current terms and pricing on the provider's official website before relying on a tool.

Tool / service	Typical use	Official website
ChatGPT	Research assistance, drafting, planning and analysis	https://chatgpt.com
Canva	Design, presentations and social graphics	https://www.canva.com
Adobe Express	Design and content creation	https://www.adobe.com/express/
Photopea	Browser-based image editing	https://www.photopea.com
remove.bg	Background removal	https://www.remove.bg
CapCut	Video editing and captions	https://www.capcut.com
Google Docs	Collaborative writing and documents	https://docs.google.com
Google Sheets	Tracking, simple databases and reporting	https://sheets.google.com
Google Forms	Questionnaires and lead capture	https://forms.google.com

Tool / service	Typical use	Official website
WhatsApp Business	Business profile, catalogue and customer messaging	https://www.whatsapp.com/business/
Meta Business Suite	Facebook and Instagram business management	https://business.facebook.com
Upwork	Freelance marketplace	https://www.upwork.com
Fiverr	Freelance services marketplace	https://www.fiverr.com
Make	Workflow automation	https://www.make.com
Zapier	Workflow automation	https://zapier.com
YouTube Studio	Channel management and analytics	https://studio.youtube.com

REFERENCES AND FURTHER READING

The following sources support selected platform and market-context statements. Tool interfaces and policies change, so revisit the official documentation before using a feature commercially.

[1] DataReportal, *Digital 2026: Nigeria*. Internet and social-media figures refer to the report's latest available data, including October 2025. https://datareportal.com/reports/digital-2026-nigeria

[2] CapCut Trust Center, legal protections and commercial-use guidance. The provider states that materials labelled for commercial use may be used for commercial projects; check the current materials licence and terms. https://www.capcut.com/trust/legal

[3] Upwork Help, *Learn about the Freelancer Service Fee*. The help article states that the fee ranges from 0% to 15% per contract and that the applicable fee is shown before contract acceptance. Check the current contract details. https://support.upwork.com/hc/en-us/articles/211062538-Learn-about-the-Freelancer-Service-Fee

[4] WhatsApp Help Center, *About catalog*. Describes catalogue item information and notes that some fields, including price, may vary by country. https://faq.whatsapp.com/405903568419894/

[5] WhatsApp Help Center, *About WhatsApp Business*. Describes business profiles and messaging tools. https://faq.whatsapp.com/641572844337957

[6] OpenAI Help Center, *ChatGPT Free Tier FAQ*. Describes access and usage limits for free-tier capabilities; limits can change. https://help.openai.com/en/articles/9275245-chatgpt-free-tier-faq

Final note to the reader

The strongest opportunity in this book is not a particular app or a secret prompt. It is the ability to understand a customer's problem, use tools responsibly, produce a useful result and communicate professionally. Start with one service. Practise until your work is dependable. Test demand honestly. Improve from evidence. Expand only when you can maintain quality.

Learn the skill. Build the proof. Find the problem. Deliver the value.

END OF BOOK

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